

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 896

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor Lt. Governor Randy McNally, Speaker of the Senate, for his exemplary service to this General Assembly and the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, we have the rare privilege to specially recognize and honor one of the most dedicated, most effective, and longest-serving elected officials this State has ever produced, namely one James Rand "Randy" McNally III of Oak Ridge; and

WHEREAS, having proudly represented his fellow citizens at the State Capitol for forty-eight years, from the 91st through the 114th General Assemblies, Lt. Governor Randy McNally has announced his retirement from the Senate at the adjournment sine die of the 2026 session, having served as a towering example for public service; and

WHEREAS, born on January 30, 1944, in Dedham, Massachusetts, Lt. Governor Randy McNally attended Oak Ridge High School; he received his Bachelor of Science degree from Memphis State University in 1967 and graduated from the University of Tennessee College of Pharmacy in 1969; and

WHEREAS, enjoying a distinguished career in health care, Lt. Governor McNally began working as a hospital pharmacist at Methodist Medical Center in Oak Ridge in 1978 and served in that capacity for more than four decades before taking his well-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, offering himself for service in Nashville, Randy McNally won election to the legislature in November 1978, when the good people of House District 33, then composed of Anderson and Roane counties, evinced their great faith in the political and governmental capabilities of the young man from Oak Ridge by electing him as their State Representative; and

WHEREAS, as a member of the House of Representatives, Lt. Governor McNally rendered sterling service as a member of the Conservation and Environment Committee, the

Labor and Consumer Affairs Committee, the Education Committee, and the Finance, Ways, and Means Committee and as the Republican Caucus Floor Leader of the 93rd and 94th General Assemblies; and

WHEREAS, in November 1986, Lt. Governor McNally won election to the Senate to represent the good people of Senate District 5, which included Anderson, Loudon, Monroe, and part of Knox counties; and

WHEREAS, prior to becoming Speaker of the Senate, Lt. Governor McNally ably served tenures as chair of the Senate Education Committee, chair and vice chair of the Senate Finance, Ways and Means Committee, chair of the Senate Finance, Ways and Means Tax Subcommittee, chair of the Joint Council on Pensions and Insurance, vice chair of the Senate Rules Committee, and member of the Senate General Welfare Committee, the Joint Select Oversight Committee on Education, the Joint Business Tax Committee, the Joint Lottery Oversight Committee, the Joint Fiscal Review Committee, and the Joint Fiscal Review Contract Services Subcommittee; and

WHEREAS, in January 2017, Randy McNally was formally elected Speaker of the Senate for the 110th General Assembly and has served with distinction in that role since that time, winning reelection to the speakership for the 111th, 112th, 113th, and 114th General Assemblies; and

WHEREAS, during his illustrious tenure in the General Assembly, Randy McNally has not only been a faithful servant of his district, he has also demonstrated the vision and fortitude necessary to move Tennessee forward as a State; and

WHEREAS, a gentleman who truly appreciates the responsibilities, as well as the privileges, of citizenship, Lt. Governor McNally has generously donated his time and energies to many community, civic, professional, and governmental organizations, including the Chamber of Commerce, the Red Cross, Oak Ridge Girls Club, Community Services for Exceptional Citizens,

Big Brother-Big Sister of Oak Ridge, the Tennessee Pharmaceutical Association, Rotary Club, Elder Citizens Advisory Board, Anderson County American Cancer Society, Anderson County Health Council, and the Advisory Board of Tennessee Donor Services; and

WHEREAS, Randy McNally has certainly been no stranger to awards and accolades during his distinguished career; he was named the Oak Ridge Jaycees Young Man of the Year in 1977, the Republican Legislator of the Year in 1990, MADD Outstanding Legislator, Sertoma Man of the Year in 1991, and Junior Leagues of Tennessee Legislator of the Year in 2005; and

WHEREAS, he received the Bill Bates Award in 1994, the Common Cause "Bird Dog" Award in 1994, the Distinguished Service Award from the University of Tennessee College of Pharmacy in 1996, the Distinguished Service Award from the American Council on Alcohol Programs in 1994, the Tennessee Organization of School Superintendents Legislative Award in 2004, the Tennessee School Boards Association Legislative Award in 2004, the Rotary Vocational Service Award in 2001, the CASA President's Award in 2012, the Legislative Hero Award from the Tennessee Association of Mental Health Organizations in 2012, the TBI Distinguished Award in 2012, the Small Business Guardian of Small Business Award in 2012, and the Distinguished Legislative Service Award from the Tennessee Association of Accessing Officers, and he was named a Paul Harris Fellow by Rotary International in 1996; and

WHEREAS, the patriarch of a loving family, he treasures the support and companionship of his wife, Jan; their two children, Melissa and Maggie; and their three grandchildren, Haley, Morgan, and Trent; and

WHEREAS, his departure from this body will truly mark the end of an era in the history of the General Assembly, as Lt. Governor McNally's retirement will create a void that will not be easily filled; his considerable talents and presence will be sorely missed by the membership of this body, the legislative staff, and the good people of Senate District 5; and

WHEREAS, this General Assembly is deeply saddened to bid farewell to our friend and colleague Lt. Governor Randy McNally; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Lt. Governor Randy McNally for his forty-eight years of distinguished service as a member of this General Assembly and his outstanding tenure as Speaker of the Senate and wish him all the best as he continues his remarkable life's journey.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.